

Blast From the Past!

Automated snapshotting and back-ups for home users.



*H*ow many times have you lost your data? Ever frantically searched for the video clip of that trip to the hills, only to realise it's lost, or rather, destroyed by a rogue hard disk? Or realised, too late, in the boardroom that the presentation you'd worked on last night to be made to your APAC head (that magically turned massive losses into sweet profits) just won't open? Instead, an 'Invalid Format: Corrupt File' error shows up.

It happens to everybody. I used to be aloof to back-ups, until one day I lost my entire hard disk to a head crash. That was just 80 gigabytes of data, but now, handling half-a-terabyte means that if this happens again, my life is more or less over. It will perhaps take me years to recreate that data. Besides, some of it is historic and is not found anywhere online. I'm

speaking of archived articles, passwords and hexadecimal passkeys for websites, networks, digitised cassettes with the originals destroyed, digitised LP Vinyl Records with originals destroyed since I've no long-playing record player... you get it. Lots of data!

Some of us religiously keep back-ups of everything including the kitchen sink. But most of us are put off by the idea of backing up our data every once in a while. It's really boring, isn't it? And yes, automated back-up solutions *do* exist, but they are notoriously complex to set up. One does get scared after reading about some guy who spent days trying to set up his automated back-up software in Linux and who then went ahead and took a back-up. Yet when his disk crashed, he could not recover his back-up due to the complexity of the software!

Many companies have been trying to